

CS151 Intro to Data Structures

Merge Sort
Quick Sort

Announcements

HW7 and Lab9 due Monday 4/19

Lab9 Manual checkoff

No class next week 4/13 and 4/15

No office hours 4/13

Which data structure would you use?

You are designing a system to manage user accounts for a large-scale web application. Each user has a unique username, and the system needs to support the following operations efficiently:

- **Add a user:** Insert a new user with a unique username and associated profile data.
- **Remove a user:** Delete a user and their profile from the system by username.
- **Get user data:** Retrieve a user's profile information by their username.
- **Check if a user exists:** Determine if a user with a specific username is registered in the system.

MergeSort

What sorting algorithms have we seen thus far?

1. Selection sort
 - a. How does it work?
 - b. Runtime complexity
2. Heap sort
 - a. How does it work?
 - b. Runtime complexity?

Divide and Conquer algorithm

1. **Divide:** recursively break down the problem into sub-problems
2. **Conquer:** recursively solve the sub-problems
3. **Combine:** combine the solutions to the sub-problems until they are a solution to the entire problem

Binary search is a divide and conquer algorithm

Usually involves recursion

Merge Sort

1. **Divide:** Divide the unsorted list into lists with only one element
2. **Conquer:** merge them back together in a sorted manner
3. **Combine:** merge the sorted sequences

Merge Sort

<https://youtu.be/4VqmGXwpLqc?si=WpYuXYLtJOuhvd77&t=24>

Merge Sort

Sort a sequence of numbers A , $|A| = n$

Base: $|A| = 1$, then it's already sorted

General

- divide: split A into two halves, each of size $\frac{n}{2}$ ($\lfloor \frac{n}{2} \rfloor$ and $\lceil \frac{n}{2} \rceil$)
- conquer: sort each half (by calling mergeSort recursively)
- combine: merge the two sorted halves into a single sorted list

Example

6	8	4	1	7	2	5	3
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

Example

6	8	4	1	7	2	5	3
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

6	8	4	1
---	---	---	---

7	2	5	3
---	---	---	---

Example

6	8	4	1	7	2	5	3
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

6	8	4	1
---	---	---	---

7	2	5	3
---	---	---	---

6	8	4	1
---	---	---	---

7	2
---	---

5	3
---	---

Example

6 8 4 1 7 2 5 3

6 8 4 1

7 2 5 3

6 8 4 1

7 2

5 3

6 8 4 1

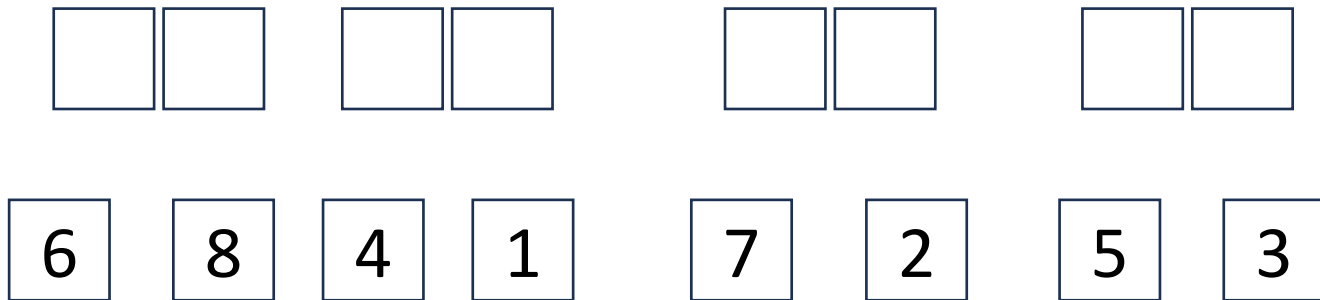
7 2

5 3

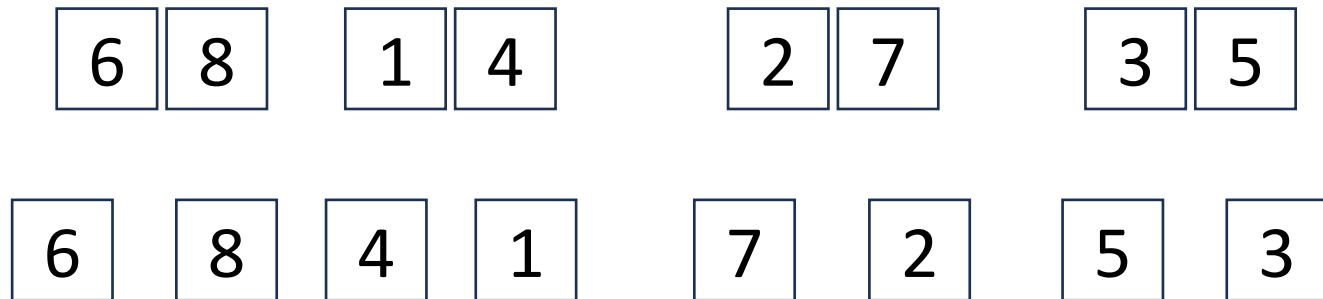
Example



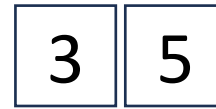
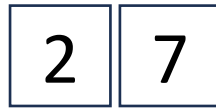
Example



Example



Example



Example

1 4 6 8

2 3 5 7

6 8 1 4

2 7

3 5

6 8 4 1

7 2 5 3

Example



1 4 6 8

2 3 5 7

6 8 1 4

2 7

3 5

6 8 4 1

7 2

5 3

Example

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

1	4	6	8
---	---	---	---

2	3	5	7
---	---	---	---

6	8	1	4
---	---	---	---

2	7
---	---

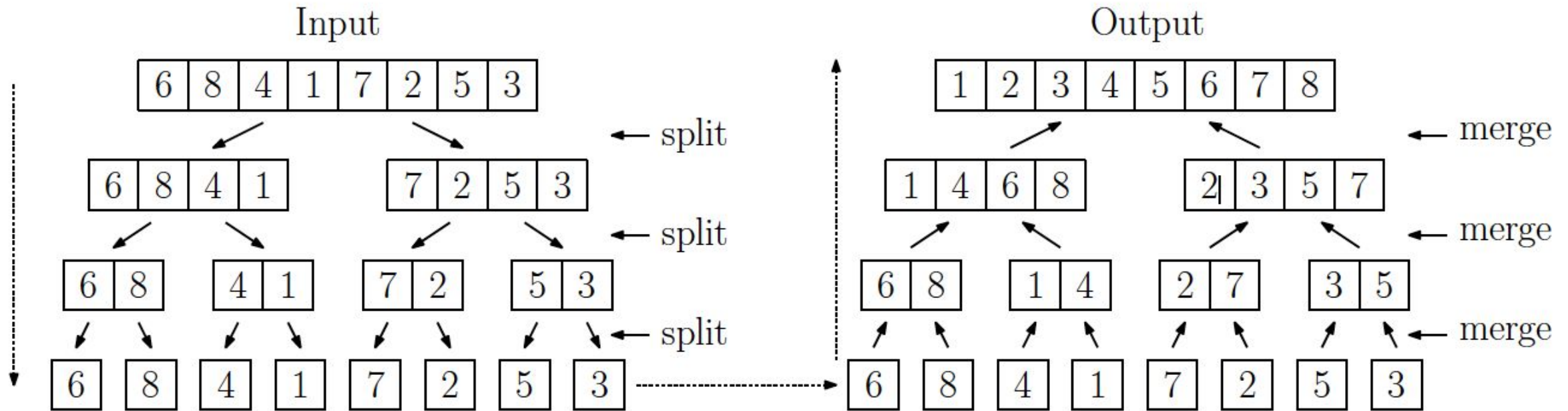
3	5
---	---

6	8	4	1
---	---	---	---

7	2
---	---

5	3
---	---

Example - summary



Merge - how do we sort two sorted lists?

```
Algorithm merge(A, B)
    S = []

    while(!A.isEmpty() and !B.isEmpty())
        if A[0] < B[0]
            S.add(A.removeFirst())
        else
            S.add(B.removeFirst())

    while (!A.isEmpty())
        S.add(A.removeFirst())
    while (!B.isEmpty())
        S.add(B.removeFirst())
    return S
```

runtime complexity?
 $O(n)$

where n is $A.length + B.length$

Merge Sort Implementation

Runtime of MergeSort

Runtime of merging two sorted two lists A, B where $|A| + |B| = n$:
 $O(n)$

How many times do we merge two sorted lists?
 $\log n$ times

So total runtime is:
 $O(n * \log(n))$

Quicksort

Quicksort

- Divide and conquer
- **Divide:** select a *pivot* and create three sequences:
 - a. L: stores elements less than the pivot
 - b. E: stores elements equal to the pivot
 - c. G: stores elements greater than the pivot
- **Conquer:** recursively sort L and G
- **Combine:** L + E + G is a sorted list

Quick Sort

1. choose a pivot
2. swap pivot to the end of the array
3. Find two items:
 - a. left which is larger than our pivot
 - b. right which is smaller than our pivot

1. swap left and right
2. repeat 3 and 4 until right < left
3. swap left and pivot
4. Sort L E and R recursively

Quick Sort - Choosing a pivot

What if we chose our pivot to be the smallest element?

We want a pivot that divides our list as evenly as possible.

Median-of-three: look at the first, middle, and last elems in the array, and pick the middle element.

Quicksort runtime complexity

Bad pivot:

$$O(n^2)$$

Good pivot:

$$O(n \log n)$$

Summary of Sorting Algorithms

Algorithm	Time
selection-sort	
heap-sort	
merge-sort	
quick-sort	

HW7 Discussion

Homework 7

- NYPD “Stop Question and Frisk” dataset
- How to work with large data

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

A **Terry stop** in the United States allows the police to briefly [detain](#) a person based on [reasonable suspicion](#) of involvement in criminal activity.^{[1][2]}

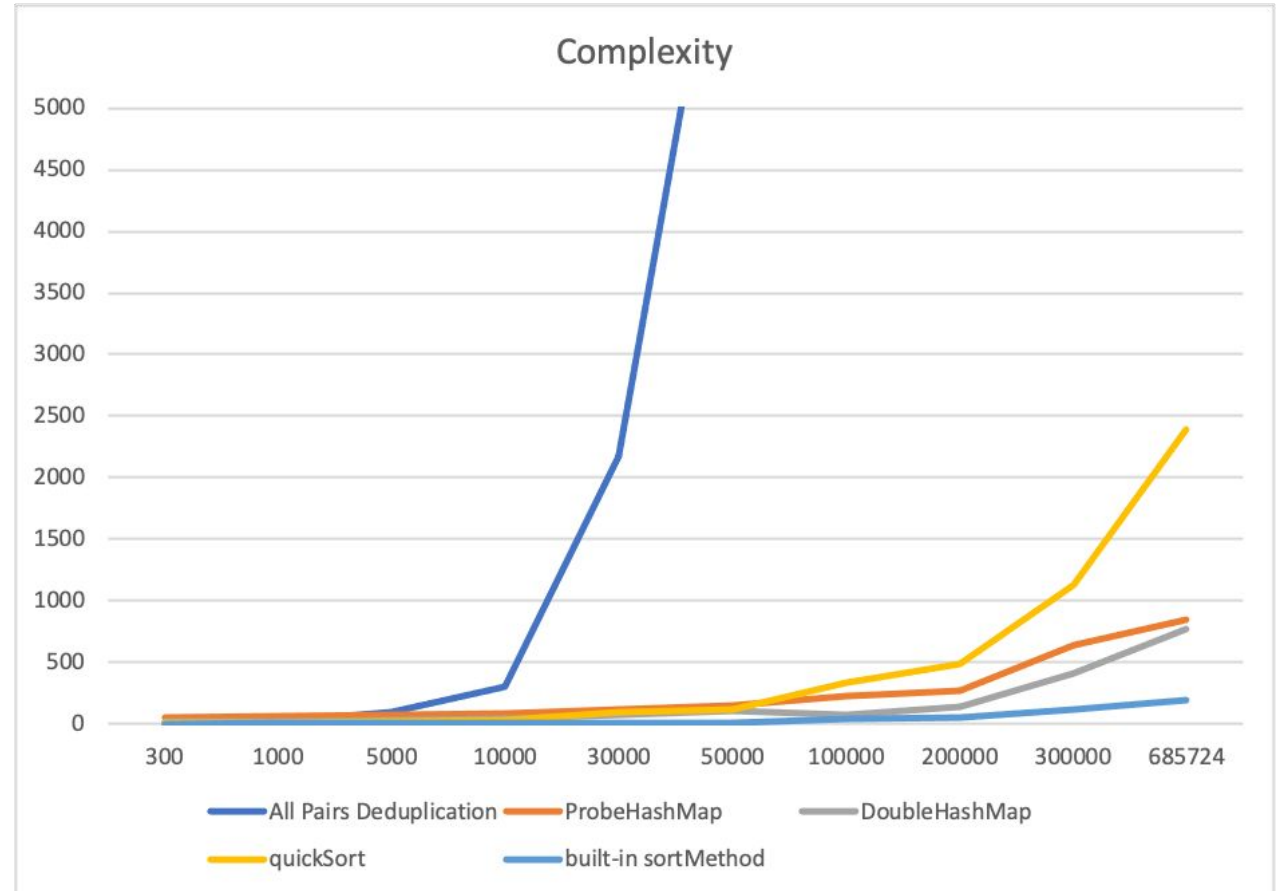
Reasonable suspicion is a lower standard than [probable cause](#) which is needed for [arrest](#). When police stop and search a pedestrian, this is commonly known as a **stop and frisk**. When police stop an automobile, this is known as a [traffic stop](#). If the police stop a motor vehicle on minor infringements in order to investigate other suspected criminal activity, this is known as a **pretextual stop**. Additional rules apply to stops that occur on a bus.^[3]

Homework 7

- How many times was the same person stopped for questioning?

Homework 7 Part 2: Complexity Analysis

- Line graph
- x axis: number of entries
- y axis: time in seconds



Summary

- Quicksort and Mergesort are **recursive $O(n \log n)$** sorting algorithms
- In quicksort, good pivots are important in achieving $O(n \log n)$ runtime complexity
- HashTable + Quicksort homework due 4/19